



# Air Quality Situation Report

Edmonton Folk Music Festival ·  
Gallagher Park

Sat, Aug 1, 2026 · 7:42 PM MDT  
For more information, contact Gary Redmond, ACA Executive Director at 780.935.4279

## Air Quality Health Index (AQHI) — Edmonton

# 5.0

Current AQHI at Edmonton McCauley (1.66 km from venue)  
Forecast Sat 9:00 PM: 3.6

| Health Risk   | AQHI | At-Risk Population                                                                                | General Population                                                                                                     |
|---------------|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Moderate Risk | 5.0  | Consider reducing or rescheduling strenuous activities outdoors if you are experiencing symptoms. | No need to modify your usual outdoor activities unless you experience symptoms such as coughing and throat irritation. |

### Active Environment Canada Alerts

**Severe Thunderstorm Watch** — City of Edmonton - St. Albert - Sherwood Park  
**Wind Warning** — City of Edmonton - St. Albert - Sherwood Park

## Environmental Intelligence Summary

- At Edmonton Folk Music Festival, temperature is 19.9°C and feels near 20.6°C. Winds are 15 km/h from NW, gusting near 40 km/h.
- Environment Canada has 2 active alert(s) in effect for the venue: severe thunderstorm watch, wind warning.
- The nearest current AQHI is 5 at Edmonton McCauley, 1.7 km from the venue.
- The official Government of Alberta AQHI for Edmonton is 4 (forecast tonight: 5, tomorrow: 3).
- A gridded AQHI estimate blending official and community sensors (confidence: High) puts the area near 4.
- The nearest air monitoring station (Edmonton McCauley, 1.7 km) reports fine particulate matter (PM<sub>2.5</sub>) at 39.5 µg/m<sup>3</sup>.
- An on-site community sensor ('ACA\_CloverdaleCL', 0.5 km) reads 35.9 µg/m<sup>3</sup> PM<sub>2.5</sub>.
- Back-trajectory modeling (HRDPS wind fields, 6 h lookback) indicates the air currently at the venue traveled from the vicinity of a point 137.8 km to the SE, i.e. arriving from the SE.
- The nearest active fire detection (NASA FIRMS – VIIRS, last 2026-08-01) is 6.0 km E of the venue. The modeled back-trajectory passes within 6.0 km of this fire, making smoke transport to the venue plausible based on wind-field modeling.
- The AQHI forecast for Sat 9:00 PM is 4.
- Thunderstorm conditions appear in the hourly forecast beginning around Sun 12:00 AM.
- Overall operational environmental risk is HIGH. Primary concerns are wind, precipitation, thunderstorm.

## Recommendations

- Confirm lightning monitoring, shelter, pause and evacuation procedures.
- Review temporary structures, signage and stage wind limits.
- Prepare drainage, electrical protection and wet-weather controls.
- Active Environment Canada alert(s) for the venue — review details: severe thunderstorm watch, wind warning.
- Environment Canada AQHI guidance — general population: No need to modify your usual outdoor activities unless you experience symptoms such as coughing and throat irritation.
- Environment Canada AQHI guidance — at-risk populations: Consider reducing or rescheduling strenuous activities outdoors if you are experiencing symptoms.

## Hazard Snapshot — Overall Risk: High Risk

|                                                                     |                                                     |                                                 |                                                       |                                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| AIR QUALITY<br><b>Moderate Risk</b><br>5.0 AQHI                     | HEAT<br><b>Low Risk</b><br>25.9 °C apparent/humidex | WIND<br><b>High Risk</b><br>77.4 km/h peak gust | PRECIPITATION<br><b>High Risk</b><br>5.9 mm/h maximum | THUNDERSTORM<br><b>High Risk</b><br>Sun 12:00 AM first forecast signal |
| WIND SHEAR<br><b>Low Risk</b><br>4.2 ° direction diff (10m vs 120m) |                                                     |                                                 |                                                       |                                                                        |

Local Monitoring

|                                                              |                                                   |                                                                     |                                                                      |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Nearest station<br><b>5.0</b><br>Edmonton McCauley · 1.66 km | Blended estimate<br><b>4.0</b><br>confidence High | PM2.5 (station)<br><b>39.5 µg/m³</b><br>Edmonton McCauley · 1.66 km | PM2.5 (community)<br><b>35.9 µg/m³</b><br>ACA_CloverdaleCL · 0.45 km |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|

Prepared by Alberta Capital Airshed for the Edmonton Folk Music Festival. Beta decision-support product — for the interactive map, live cameras and hourly outlook, scan the QR code or visit [https://dkevinm.github.io/environmental\\_intelligence\\_edmonton/](https://dkevinm.github.io/environmental_intelligence_edmonton/)

